New Beekeeper Equipment Checklist

Print this page and tick each item as you gather your kit.

Protective gear

- [ ] Veil, jacket or full suit
- [ ] Gloves (nitrile or leather)
- [ ] Boots, with trousers tucked in

Tools

- [ ] Smoker, fuel (burlap, pine needles) and matches
- [ ] Hive tool, plus a spare
- [ ] Soft bee brush
- [ ] Frame grip (optional)

The hive

- [ ] Bottom board and entrance reducer
- [ ] Two brood boxes with frames and foundation
- [ ] Queen excluder
- [ ] Two or more honey supers with frames
- [ ] Inner cover and outer cover
- [ ] Stand that keeps the hive off the ground

Feeding and health

- [ ] Feeder and sugar for syrup
- [ ] Varroa monitoring kit (sugar roll jar or sticky board)
- [ ] Notebook or app for hive records

Before your bees arrive

- [ ] Choose a sunny, sheltered spot with a water source
- [ ] Tell your neighbors, and register your hives if required
- [ ] Book a mentor through the association